A Walk Through Subversion 1.6

The latest Subversion was released recently, and it's time to find out what's new.

Subversion (svn) is a popular free software version control system that is widely used by a lot of developers across the world. Many popular community sites like SourceForge.net, OpenOffice.org, Netbeans, Tigris, etc, provide Subversion hosting for collaborative development.

This article takes you through some of the important features of the Subversion 1.6 release that benefits both users and the developers.

Tree conflicts

A tree conflict is visualised as a 'conflict on a directory', unlike a conflict on a file or property. Subversion 1.6 detects a tree conflict and intimates the user with the help of ***svn status***, where a tree conflict is shown by a "C" in the fourth column of the status output. A tree conflict must be manually resolved by the user, without which committing changes becomes impossible.

For example, two users, A and B, are at work on different working copies, *wcA* and *wcB*, respectively. User A makes some changes to *Foo.c* file and commits it to the repository. Simultaneously, User B moves the file Foo.c to *Bar.c*. Now, B tries to update her working copy, which will make *Foo.c* to go into a 'conflicted state'. In older releases of Subversion, this does not happen—*Foo.c* receives the changes done by User A which is scheduled for deletion and user is not aware of the tree conflict. In Subversion 1.6, the user must resolve the conflicted state of Bar.c, and